

learned. He had a lot going on by that age, which is just when *Common Stocks and Uncommon Profits* appeared.

The book's publication tied into other personal qualities that were weird. Note his dedication in *Common Stocks and Uncommon Profits*. It says, "This book is dedicated to all investors, large and small, who do NOT adhere to the philosophy: 'I have already made up my mind, don't confuse me with facts.' " As long as I knew him, in any area outside investing, he didn't want to be confused with facts because he didn't want his life disrupted because he was a creature of habit, almost above and beyond all things. Everything had to stay just as it was. You couldn't replace anything with a new-and-improved version. That he tore down his house and re-built it was miraculous. He just didn't want facts if they might lead him to change. It impacted everything from his garden to his cars, clothes, furniture, acquaintances; whatever it was, he didn't want change. When I worked for him briefly, I didn't really know him well at first in a business sense, but I could see that his office was antiquated. So I set out to do minor improvements.

In 1972, he still had a battery of three rotary-dial telephones on his desk, and he was hard of hearing. So, he would be talking on one and another would ring and he would have no idea which one it was; and he would regularly pick up the wrong one and slam it back down hurrying to the other. I installed a standard single-set, touch-tone phone with multiple lines and flashing lights. It took him months to get over being mad at me. I interfered with his world, and he could not accept it as an improvement. But he learned the business point of it, and for business he would change; and he finally got used to it—it became a new habit and he forgot he was ever mad at me. But when I was four-teen and used money I'd saved from working part-time jobs to buy him a jacket to wear in the woods with me on a family trip, he would never wear it, preferring to wear, believe it or not, an old sport coat he had owned forever. He hated change.

He had an old hand-crank adding machine in his office that was probably first operated by *Tyrannosaurus rex*. When I first saw him pounding on that darned thing, I thought his desk would implode or his wrist would shatter. Three feet from where I sit now, I have a collection of memorabilia. One item, from his office, was an October 20, 1961, *Wall Street Journal* announcement of what was the first four-function calculator. It